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The Phenomenon of Religious Misinformation and the Challenges of Authority in the Artificial Intelligence Ecosystem

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Abstract

The rapid development of Artificial Intelligence (AI) has transformed the way society accesses and understands religious information through social media, search engines, and AI-based chatbots. This condition creates challenges related to religious misinformation, algorithmic bias, and the shift of religious authority from traditional scholars to digital platforms. This study aims to analyze the characteristics of religious misinformation in the AI ecosystem, examine the crisis of religious authority, and formulate a religious moderation strategy based on digital literacy. The research employed a qualitative descriptive method with a library research approach. Data were collected from scientific journals, books, reports, and recent studies related to AI, digital religion, and religious moderation. Data analysis used critical and interpretative content analysis through data reduction, categorization, interpretation, and conclusion drawing. The findings reveal that AI algorithms contribute to filter bubbles, echo chambers, fragmented religious understanding, and AI hallucination in religious discourse. Digital popularity increasingly replaces sanad-based authority and creates algorithmic authority in religious practices. Religious moderation based on wasathiyah values and digital tabayyun literacy becomes an important strategy to mitigate radicalization and misinformation in digital spaces. AI should function as an educational assistant, while moral and theological authority remains centered on scholars and religious institutions.

Keywords: *artificial intelligence; digital literacy; digital religion; religious misinformation; religious moderation*

Introduction

The massive digital transformation that has taken place over the last two decades has fundamentally changed various aspects of human life, including the way people understand, access, and practice religious teachings. The emergence of the internet, social media, Artificial Intelligence (AI), machine learning, and digital algorithms has created a new religious landscape in which religious activities are increasingly shifting from conventional domains into a digital-based ecosystem. Consequently, religion is no longer studied solely through formal institutions such as schools, Islamic boarding schools, or religious assemblies, but also through digital platforms such as YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, WhatsApp, AI chatbots, and search engines that provide instant and borderless access to religious information. This technological development offers convenience, efficiency, and broad accessibility to religious knowledge through virtual assistants based on Natural Language Processing (NLP).

Data from the Indonesian Internet Service Providers Association (APJII) in 2024 show that internet penetration in Indonesia reached 79.5%, or approximately 221 million users. In

addition, the APJII survey in 2025 revealed that social media has become one of the most dominant digital activities among Indonesian society. Reports from We Are Social and Katadata also explain that platforms such as YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, and WhatsApp are among the most frequently used media by Indonesians to access information, including educational and religious content (APJII, 2024). This condition demonstrates that social media has evolved into one of the primary sources of religious learning, particularly among younger generations who are highly connected to digital technology.

Although digital technology provides convenience and efficiency in disseminating religious teachings, it also presents serious challenges in the form of religious misinformation, algorithmic bias, and the shifting of traditional religious authority. Mahud (2025) explains that the algorithmic era has radically transformed the structure of the production and distribution of religious meaning. Social media algorithms tend to prioritize popularity and user engagement rather than scientific validity, causing religious authority to shift from scholars grounded in *sanad* (chains of transmission) toward highly visible digital figures. As a result, a crisis of religious literacy and religious disorientation has emerged, especially among younger generations who are more likely to trust machine-generated information than authoritative spiritual guidance.

The phenomenon becomes increasingly complex when AI systems and social media platforms create echo chambers or digital resonance spaces that reinforce particular religious views without encouraging critical dialogue. Personalization algorithms often trap users within information environments that merely strengthen existing biases, thereby contributing to intolerance, radicalism, and polarization in the digital public sphere. Recommendation systems on platforms such as YouTube and TikTok illustrate how algorithms can gradually direct users toward more extreme content after they initially interact with moderate religious lectures. For example, users who watch moderate discussions on religious identity or moral issues may later receive recommendations containing exclusive interpretations, provocative narratives, or radical ideological perspectives because such content tends to generate higher engagement rates. Similarly, TikTok's "For You Page" algorithm continuously promotes emotionally charged and controversial religious content once users interact with related videos, creating a cycle of ideological reinforcement. These patterns demonstrate that digital algorithms are not entirely neutral, but actively shape patterns of religious understanding and behavior in contemporary society.

The spread of religious misinformation in Indonesia can also be observed through various viral cases on digital platforms. Religious narratives are frequently manipulated through edited sermon clips taken out of context, provocative titles intended to trigger conflict among communities, and fabricated claims regarding religious laws and worship practices circulated through TikTok, YouTube, Facebook, and WhatsApp. In several cases, old sermon videos have been reuploaded with misleading narratives, causing public misunderstanding and social tension. Such conditions indicate that social media does not merely function as a medium of information dissemination, but also as a space capable of amplifying polarization and social conflict when not accompanied by adequate digital literacy and critical awareness (Kominfo, 2023).

Several previous studies have identified that the use of AI in da'wah activities presents major challenges, particularly in the form of authority degradation and the diminishing spirituality of direct human interaction (Marwantika, 2023). Although AI technology offers extraordinary efficiency in disseminating religious messages, Marwantika (2023) also highlights the risks of semantic bias and the potential manipulation of religious content through deepfake technology, which may undermine the quality and authenticity of religious discourse. Furthermore, the widespread circulation of religious hoaxes and sermon excerpts detached

from their original context has made it increasingly difficult for society to distinguish between authoritative teachings and manipulative narratives driven by ideological interests. In Indonesia, these challenges are particularly significant because the spread of religious misinformation not only affects the quality of religious understanding but also has the potential to disrupt social harmony and national stability within a pluralistic society.

The primary objective of this research is to comprehensively analyze the characteristics of religious misinformation in the era of artificial intelligence and to identify the influence of algorithmic systems on patterns of religious understanding in society. In addition, this study seeks to explain the role of religious moderation as an instrument of ethical navigation and to formulate strategies for strengthening moderation through digital literacy that is adaptive to AI developments. In this context, religious moderation should no longer be understood merely as a normative concept, but rather as a movement of critical literacy capable of fostering verification and *tabayyun* skills amidst the uncontrolled flow of automated information.

The urgency of this research lies in the need for a new framework in education and da'wah capable of addressing the challenges of the Industrial Revolution 5.0. Through the integration of moderation values (*wasathiyah*) and technological literacy skills, this research is expected to contribute theoretically to the development of religious studies in the era of digital disruption. Practically, the findings of this study are intended to provide strategic recommendations for governments, educational institutions, and religious leaders in building a healthy, tolerant, and civilized digital ecosystem in order to preserve national integration and harmonious social life.

Methods

This study employs a descriptive qualitative approach using a library research method to examine in depth the phenomenon of religious misinformation within the artificial intelligence ecosystem. The selection of this method is based on the need to explore abstract concepts related to digital authority, algorithmic systems, and religious discourse that are rapidly developing in contemporary academic literature (Mahud, 2025). The library research method is considered appropriate because it enables researchers to critically examine various scientific sources, conceptual frameworks, and findings from previous studies relevant to issues of religion and digital technology (Zed, 2014; Snyder, 2019). Furthermore, the qualitative approach provides space for researchers to interpret social phenomena contextually and comprehensively, particularly regarding the interaction between religion, artificial intelligence, and digital media in contemporary society (Creswell & Creswell, 2018).

A. Data Sources and Data Collection Techniques

The primary data sources in this study consist of secondary literature documents related to artificial intelligence, digital religion, religious moderation, algorithmic communication, and misinformation studies. Data collection techniques were conducted through a systematic literature review of reputable scientific journals indexed in Scopus, Web of Science, and Sinta 1–2, as well as academic books and research reports published within the last five years to ensure the relevance and timeliness of the information (Snyder, 2019). The literature search process was carried out systematically through academic databases such as Scopus, Google Scholar, ScienceDirect, and Dimensions using keywords such as "religious misinformation," "AI and religion," "digital da'wah," "algorithmic radicalization," and "religious moderation in digital media."

Furthermore, the researchers applied inclusion and exclusion criteria to select references specifically discussing the limitations of AI in da'wah, the influence of machine learning algorithms on religious discourse, and the sociological implications of digital media on

religious moderation (Marwantika, 2023). This procedure follows the principles of systematic review, which emphasize transparency, relevance, and academic rigor in selecting literature sources (Xiao & Watson, 2019). Therefore, the collected data possess strong academic validity and are relevant to the current context of digital disruption and religious transformation.

B. Research Focus and Variables

The focus of this study is directed toward three major elements interacting within the digital ecosystem. These elements include: (1) the characteristics of religious misinformation generated and disseminated through AI-based digital platforms, (2) patterns of shifting traditional religious authority in the era of algorithmic communication, and (3) the effectiveness of religious moderation strategies in countering digital radicalization and misinformation. Thus, this study not only examines technological dimensions, but also incorporates sociological, theological, and communication perspectives in understanding how society consumes and interprets religious information in digital spaces (Campbell, 2013).

C. Data Analysis Procedure

The data analysis procedure was conducted using critical content analysis and interpretative analysis techniques. Critical content analysis was selected because it enables researchers to identify ideological tendencies, patterns of representation, and implicit meanings within digital religious discourse (Krippendorff, 2018). The stages of analysis began with data reduction, namely the process of selecting and categorizing information most relevant to the objectives of the study, followed by systematic data presentation and thematic classification (Miles, Huberman, & Saldaña, 2014).

After the data had been organized, the researcher conducted an interpretative verification process by connecting the literature findings with the framework of religious moderation and digital literacy developed in Indonesia. This analytical strategy was employed to formulate a conceptual model of digital literacy capable of minimizing the negative impacts of artificial intelligence without neglecting the efficiency and accessibility offered by digital technology (Marwantika, 2023). In addition, interpretative analysis assists researchers in critically understanding the relationship between algorithmic systems, digital culture, and the transformation of religious authority in contemporary society (Fuchs, 2021).

Results and Discussion

A. Transformation of the Religious Information Ecosystem in the Era of Artificial Intelligence

This study is based on three main research questions: (1) how religious misinformation is characterized within the Artificial Intelligence ecosystem, (2) how AI influences traditional religious authority, and (3) how religious moderation can serve as a mitigation strategy amidst the dominance of digital algorithms. Based on the literature analysis, these three issues are interconnected and form new dynamics within the religious life of modern society.

The findings of the literature analysis indicate that the development of Artificial Intelligence (AI) has significantly transformed the patterns of production, distribution, and consumption of religious information. This transformation is marked by the emergence of algorithm-based digital spaces that enable information to spread rapidly without undergoing authoritative verification processes as practiced in classical Islamic scholarly traditions. In this context, AI no longer functions merely as a tool for information retrieval, but has evolved into a primary mediator in shaping public religious understanding.

This phenomenon can be observed through the growing habit of people accessing religious preaching content through social media platforms such as TikTok, Instagram Reels,

and YouTube Shorts. Religious content is now consumed rapidly through short videos, sermon excerpts, and instant answers generated by AI chatbots. For the digital generation, social media has become a "new classroom" for learning religion.

Based on the literature analysis, this phenomenon has created what is referred to as hyper-religious information, namely a condition in which society receives an overwhelming amount of religious information, although not all of it possesses academic or theological validity. Digital algorithms operate on the principle of an engagement-oriented system, meaning that content with high interaction rates is more likely to be recommended than content with substantial scientific depth. Consequently, provocative, controversial, and emotional religious narratives tend to dominate over moderate and educational explanations.

Mahud (2025) explains that AI within the modern digital ecosystem functions as a "knowledge curator" that determines the type of information most frequently consumed by users. In practice, this system does not consider the validity of Islamic law but instead analyzes user behavior patterns based on search history, clicks, viewing duration, and social media interactions. This condition has caused traditional religious authority to shift, as people increasingly rely on search engines, AI chatbots, and social media platforms for religious answers.

This shift demonstrates that digital spaces have created a new model of authority that is algorithmic in nature. Whereas scholarly legitimacy was previously obtained through *sanad* (chains of transmission), *talaqqi* (direct learning), and recognition from the scholarly community, in the AI era legitimacy is often shaped through digital popularity such as follower counts, views, likes, and content virality. This transformation presents a serious challenge to religious moderation because people are more inclined to accept instant information rather than scientific explanations that require deeper learning processes.

B. Characteristics of Religious Misinformation in AI Systems

The findings reveal that religious misinformation in the AI era possesses characteristics distinct from misinformation in the conventional media era. Previously, the spread of false information still depended directly on human actors. However, within modern AI systems, misinformation dissemination has been reinforced by algorithmic automation mechanisms capable of replicating and massively expanding information distribution. Based on content analysis of various literature sources, through processes of data reduction, categorization, and interpretation, this study identifies three major patterns of religious misinformation within the AI ecosystem.

1. Fragmentation of Religious Understanding

   The first phenomenon is the fragmentation of religious understanding through short-form social media content such as short videos, sermon excerpts, and partial quotations of Qur'anic verses or hadiths. Digital platform algorithms tend to prioritize short and easily consumable content. As a result, religious discussions that should require historical, methodological, and philosophical contexts become oversimplified.

   Analysis of various studies shows that this condition causes users to gain only partial religious understanding without comprehending legal backgrounds, *asbabun nuzul* (occasions of revelation), or differences among scholars' opinions. From the perspective of religious moderation, such fragmentation is dangerous because it can produce textual and exclusive mindsets vulnerable to intolerance.

   Furthermore, the culture of rapid information consumption leads society to neglect the process of *tabayyun* or information verification. Religious teachings are no longer studied through in-depth *talaqqi* processes but are instead consumed instantly through fragmented digital content that often loses its academic substance.

2. Information Hallucination by AI Chatbots

The second finding relates to the phenomenon of AI hallucination. In the religious context, AI chatbots may generate convincing answers despite lacking valid scriptural foundations. Generative AI systems operate based on language probability rather than substantive understanding of fiqh, ushul fiqh, or interpretative methodologies.

Marwantika (2023) explains that current Artificial Narrow Intelligence (ANI) systems possess major limitations in understanding cultural contexts, the nuances of religious language, and the complexities of theological issues. AI may produce linguistically logical responses, yet these responses may be substantively incorrect in religious terms.

Various contemporary studies indicate that this phenomenon has become a serious problem because many people have started using AI chatbots as primary references for everyday religious questions. When AI-generated answers are accepted without verification from competent religious authorities, the risk of spreading inaccurate fatwas and deviant understandings becomes increasingly significant.

3. Amplification of Extreme Narratives by Algorithms

The third characteristic is the amplification of extreme narratives through digital recommendation systems. Social media algorithms are designed to maintain user attention for as long as possible. Therefore, these systems tend to recommend content capable of triggering strong emotions such as anger, fear, or fanaticism. In the religious context, this condition causes intolerant, provocative, and radical narratives to spread more easily than moderate content, which is generally reflective and educational in nature. AI systems analyze user preferences and continuously provide similar content, thereby creating echo chambers. The echo chamber phenomenon narrows an individual's religious perspective because users are exposed only to views that align with their existing beliefs. As a result, opportunities for intergroup dialogue become increasingly limited, while social polarization intensifies.

C. Crisis of Religious Authority in the Algorithmic Era

The synthesis of various previous studies demonstrates a shift in religious legitimacy from *sanad*-based authority toward digital popularity-based authority. Traditional legitimacy structures, which were previously built through *talaqqi*, mastery of knowledge, and recognition by the scholarly community, have changed due to the dominance of social media and algorithmic systems. The tendency of younger generations to seek answers to religious issues through search engines and AI chatbots reflects the emergence of the phenomenon known as "from teacher to Google." This change indicates that the process of seeking fatwas and religious understanding is now influenced more by the speed of information access than by the depth of the learning process.

The culture of short-form content further intensifies this authority crisis. Short sermon clips encourage people to consume religious teachings partially without understanding legal backgrounds, *asbabun nuzul*, or differences among scholars' perspectives. This situation increases the risk of reducing religious teachings into emotional slogans that easily go viral.

Mahud (2025) describes this condition as "trending epistemology," namely a situation in which social legitimacy is formed based on digital popularity rather than scholarly quality. Social media algorithms ultimately function as determinants of the visibility of religious figures in the digital public sphere. This condition gives rise to what is called trust in visibility, namely the tendency of people to trust figures who appear most frequently on their social media timelines.

Table 1. Comparison of the Characteristics of Traditional Religious Authority and AI-Based Digital Authority

Characteristics	Traditional Authority	Digital/AI Authority
Source of Truth	*Sanad* and Scholarship	Algorithms and Engagement
Learning Process	*Talaqqi* and Long-term Study	Instant Information Retrieval
Validation	Peer Review among Ulama	Social Validation (Likes/Shares)
Interpretation	Hermeneutics and Contextual Understanding	Statistical and Probabilistic Patterns
Educational Orientation	Ethical and Spiritual Formation	Efficiency and Speed
Religious Interaction	Humanistic and Dialogical	Automated and Machine-Based

Source: Adapted from Mahud (2025) and Marwantika (2023)

The data presented in Table 1 demonstrate a fundamental transformation in the structure of religious authority in the era of Artificial Intelligence. Traditional authority, which was previously built upon scholarly *sanad* (chains of transmission), *talaqqi* processes, and recognition from the scholarly community, has gradually shifted toward systems based on algorithms and digital visibility. This transformation indicates that modern religious legitimacy is increasingly influenced by the logic of social media engagement rather than by the depth of religious scholarship.

The process of religious learning has also undergone significant changes. The tradition of *talaqqi*, which emphasizes direct interaction between teacher and student, is slowly being replaced by instant information retrieval systems through search engines and AI chatbots. Although this situation provides efficiency in accessing information, it simultaneously reduces the spiritual, ethical, and reflective dimensions that have long characterized traditional Islamic education. The aspect of knowledge validation has likewise changed due to the dominance of digital media. The peer review mechanism among religious scholars, which previously served as the basis of scholarly legitimacy, is now often displaced by social validation measured through likes, shares, views, and followers. This condition shows that digital popularity is increasingly perceived by parts of society as an indicator of truth.

Differences in interpretative orientation also reveal a striking contrast. The hermeneutic and contextual approaches employed by traditional scholars aim to understand religious texts comprehensively based on social, historical, and methodological conditions. In contrast, AI systems operate through statistical patterns and language probabilities without the capacity to deeply comprehend moral or spiritual dimensions. Consequently, AI is vulnerable to generating religious responses that are partial and lacking contextual understanding.

AI-based religious education tends to prioritize efficiency and speed in information distribution, whereas traditional Islamic education emphasizes the formation of morality, ethics (adab), and spiritual maturity. These differences illustrate that digital technological development not only changes the medium of religious learning but also transforms how society interprets authority, validity, and religious experience as a whole.

D. Filter Bubble and Echo Chamber in Digital Spaces

Studies on religious misinformation cannot be separated from the theories of filter bubbles and echo chambers. Digital media literature explains that social media algorithms automatically filter information based on search history, user preferences, and digital interaction patterns. This mechanism causes users to receive information that aligns primarily with their personal beliefs. Several studies on social media algorithms show that users who once accessed intolerant narratives tend to continuously receive similar recommendations. This situation narrows the space for dialogue and strengthens confirmation bias. Echo chambers are eventually formed when digital interactions occur only within groups sharing similar perspectives.

Algorithmic radicalization emerges as recommendation systems continuously reinforce exposure to extreme narratives. This issue demonstrates that digital technology is not entirely neutral because algorithmic structures are designed according to the logic of the attention economy. Content that provokes emotions is more likely to gain broad distribution than content promoting peaceful dialogue.

E. Religious Moderation as a Techno-Spiritual Strategy

The concept of religious moderation developed by the Indonesian Ministry of Religious Affairs is grounded in the principle of *wasathiyah*, which emphasizes balance, justice, tolerance, and respect for local cultural diversity. The four main indicators of moderation include national commitment, tolerance, anti-violence, and accommodative attitudes toward local culture.

The principles of *i'tidal* and *tawazun* possess strong relevance to the challenges of modern digital spaces. *I'tidal* reflects uprightness and fairness, while *tawazun* emphasizes balanced thinking. The integration of these two principles plays an important role in protecting society from both digital extremism and unrestricted liberalism.

The synthesis of various studies demonstrates the urgency of transforming religious moderation into a techno-spiritual approach. This approach integrates digital literacy with Islamic spiritual values such as *tabayyun, tasamuh, tawassuth,* and *i'tidal*. Its primary focus is not merely related to the ability to use technology, but also to building critical awareness of digital algorithm mechanisms. The principle of *tabayyun* occupies an important position as the foundation for verifying religious information. Algorithmic awareness is necessary so that society understands that social media content is the result of machine selection rather than an objective representation of social reality.

F. Development of Moderate AI as a Mitigation Strategy

The synthesis of digital education studies shows that the use of generative AI can increase learning interactivity through material personalization and adaptive learning systems. Rubini and Aisyah (2026) explain that AI contributes to improving the effectiveness of Islamic Religious Education through learning analytics-based approaches. Nevertheless, AI has serious limitations regarding moral judgment, spirituality, and the validity of religious law. Large Language Model (LLM) systems operate solely through language probability prediction without understanding ethical values or theological contexts in depth. The risk of AI hallucination enables chatbots to generate religious answers that appear convincing despite lacking valid scientific foundations.

The human-in-the-loop approach becomes an important strategy for maintaining balance between technological efficiency and human scholarly authority. In this framework, AI functions as a learning assistant, while teachers and religious scholars continue to serve as the primary moral and intellectual curators.

Table 2. Strategic Indicators of Digital Transformation and Religious Moderation in Indonesia

Strategic Indicator	Verified Data / Achievement	Implications for Education and Moderation
National Internet Penetration	79.5% of Indonesia's population (221.5 million users)	Digital spaces have become one of the main sources of religious information and learning
Internet Penetration Among Generation Z	87.02% internet penetration among Gen Z	Younger generations are highly exposed to digital religious content and algorithmic influence
Internet Penetration in Urban Areas	82.2% urban internet penetration	Religious discourse increasingly develops within digital public spaces

National Digital Literacy Index	Digital Literacy Index reached 3.65 out of 5.00	Critical verification and information filtering skills still need strengthening
AI-Based Learning Development	AI increasingly utilized in digital learning and educational assistance	AI can support religious education, but requires ethical supervision and verification literacy
Spread of Religious Misinformation	Religious hoaxes remain dominant on social media and messaging platforms	Digital literacy and religious moderation are necessary to reduce misinformation

Source: Compiled and synthesized from APJII Internet Penetration Survey 2024, Kominfo Digital Literacy Index 2023, Kominfo Hoax and Digital Disinformation Reports 2023, and Indonesia National Artificial Intelligence Strategy Reports (BRIN, 2023).

Table 2 illustrates several strategic indicators related to digital transformation and its implications for religious moderation and education in Indonesia. The data demonstrate that digital technology has become an inseparable part of Indonesian society's daily life, particularly in accessing information, including religious content. APJII data in 2024 show that Indonesia's internet penetration reached 79.5% of the total population, equivalent to approximately 221.5 million users. This figure indicates that digital spaces have increasingly become one of the primary sources of religious learning and information dissemination within society.

The table also reveals that internet penetration among Generation Z reached 87.02%, indicating that younger generations are highly connected to digital platforms and continuously exposed to algorithm-driven information flows. This condition has significant implications for the formation of religious understanding because young people tend to consume religious information through social media platforms such as YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, and WhatsApp rather than through conventional religious institutions. In urban areas, internet penetration reached 82.2%, further confirming that digital discourse, including religious narratives, increasingly develops within online public spaces.

In terms of digital literacy, the National Digital Literacy Index released by Kominfo in 2023 reached 3.65 out of 5.00. Although this score falls within the "moderate" category, it indicates that critical verification skills and the ability to filter information among the public still require strengthening. This condition becomes particularly important in the context of religious misinformation because individuals with low digital literacy are more vulnerable to consuming and disseminating unverified religious content, provocative narratives, and manipulative information circulating on social media platforms.

Furthermore, the table demonstrates that artificial intelligence technology is increasingly utilized in digital learning and educational assistance. AI-based systems are considered capable of improving learning efficiency and interactivity, including within religious education contexts. However, the increasing use of AI also presents risks related to misinformation, hallucinated information, and algorithmic bias if users lack adequate verification abilities. Therefore, ethical supervision and digital literacy are necessary to ensure that AI functions as a supportive educational tool rather than a source of misinformation.

The final indicator highlights that religious misinformation and digital hoaxes continue to spread widely through social media and messaging platforms. Reports from Kominfo indicate that religious-related misinformation remains one of the recurring categories of digital hoaxes in Indonesia. This condition demonstrates that strengthening digital literacy and religious moderation is essential to reduce the spread of misinformation, prevent polarization, and maintain social harmony within Indonesia's pluralistic society. Overall, the table confirms that the rapid growth of digital technology must be balanced with critical literacy, ethical awareness, and moderation values to create a healthy and tolerant digital ecosystem.

Conclusion

The development of Artificial Intelligence has transformed the patterns of society's consumption of religious information through digital algorithm systems that prioritize popularity and engagement over scholarly validity. This situation has given rise to various forms of religious misinformation, fragmented understanding, and a shift in authority from *sanad*-based scholars toward digital authority based on algorithmic visibility. The findings of this study demonstrate that the research objectives were successfully achieved through the identification of the characteristics of religious misinformation, the analysis of the crisis of digital authority, and the formulation of moderation strategies based on digital literacy and techno-spiritual approaches.

The concept of religious moderation holds an important position as an ethical framework for addressing algorithmic radicalization and digital disruption. Strengthening algorithmic awareness, fostering a culture of digital *tabayyun*, and developing Moderate AI grounded in the values of *wasathiyah* are essential strategies for preserving the quality of public religious understanding in the era of the Industrial Revolution 5.0. AI should continue to be positioned as a learning support tool, while moral authority and religious validity must remain under the guidance of scholars, teachers, and Islamic educational institutions.

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